

CHAPTER TWO: THE KITHAIN

"It's like everyone tells a story about themselves inside their own head. Always. All the time. That story makes you what you are. We build ourselves out of that story."

— Patrick Rothfuss, *The Name of the Wind*

Humans define themselves by more than just species. They identify with certain races and cultures, separate themselves by generation or ideology, and express individuality while simultaneously looking for ways to connect with others like them. How they look, who they love, where they live, what they believe — these are all building blocks of identity. Changelings, likewise, define themselves and their identities in many ways, layered on top of who they are in their mortal life. Many still embrace the ties of their mortal seemings, but their faerie selves bring with them additional traditions, abilities, and communities.

This chapter explores the building blocks that come together to form a changeling. These aspects of a changeling's identity — her seeming, kith, and house — are not the only important elements in her life, but they provide a vital framework through which to understand her and her place in the world. The descriptions of the mortal and fae seemings, the many kiths that people the realm of the Kithain, and the noble houses to which changeling may swear fealty

will give you the information you need to create a dynamic character to play in this game.

Seeming

Though a changeling's body ages at the same rate as her mortal companions, her fae nature isn't held by such things as linear time. It's a changeling's mindset that dictates her seeming — the way she views the world around her, and her connection to Glamour and the Dreaming. A changeling moves between three seemings: childlings embrace the wonder and unlimited possibilities of the world, wilders confront it with reckless abandon, and grumps have settled into roles as teachers and guides for new changelings. With their varied perspectives, the different seemings are likely to react to Banality triggers (p. 269) in markedly unique ways. Childlings attempt to avoid them at all cost, viewing the invitation to such mundane forces an affront to their very nature, wilders are more likely to invite them sparingly, as tools, weapons, or last-ditch defenses, and grumps